CSV TO EXCEL: KEEP BARCODE AS TEXT

Import the CSV before Excel converts long barcodes into numbers.

Why this matters

CSV stores the barcode as digits, but opening a CSV directly can make Excel treat it as a number. Excel may then display a long barcode in scientific notation or change its digits. Import the Barcode column as Text instead.

Import steps

1. Open Excel to a blank workbook. Do not double-click the CSV file.
2. Select Data > From Text/CSV, then choose the downloaded CSV.
3. In the preview window, select Transform Data.
4. In Power Query, select the Barcode column.
5. Set its data type to Text (not Whole Number or Decimal Number).
   If Excel asks, choose Replace Current.
6. Check Applied Steps. If a Changed Type step made Barcode numeric,
   remove that step, then set Barcode to Text again.
7. Select Home > Close & Load to import the data into Excel.

Check the result

The Barcode cell should show the complete value, for example:

7400000039262053840301

If it shows something like 7.400000039E+21, close without saving and repeat the import, making sure the column is Text before Close & Load.

Tip: After importing, save the workbook as Excel Workbook (*.xlsx).